

M48 — Nurses-station alarm thresholds + per-metric cadence + ECG cosmetic fix

Phase: Phase 7 follow-on (post-M47, operator feature request) **Status:** **DONE** **Blocked by:** M22 (Per-Patient Console), M23 (telemetry snapshot), M24 (ECG waveform library), M26 (alarm bus), M27 (Nursing Station)

Blocks: none **Estimated effort:** 0.75 day

1. Purpose

Three operator asks bundled in one paragraph:

"Alarm levels set on nurses station: Heart rate, O2 sat, Respiration, Dangerous wave forms. BP update unless injected, update every 2 minutes, temp every minute, respirations every 30 seconds, pulse ox every 10 seconds. ECG trace line needs to be thinner and not look like its glowing."

Delivered:

- 1. Operator-settable alarm thresholds on the Nursing Station.** New settings card on the supervisor page (`nurse_station.html`) for low/high bounds on HR, SpO₂, RR plus a "dangerous waveforms" checkbox list (v-fib, v-tach, asystole, a-fib RVR, 3° block). Thresholds live on `room.alarm_thresholds` (in-memory, room-level). The alarm bus (`alarms.py`) checks every encounter's telemetry snapshot against these on every `/api/room/alarms` tick; breaches surface as `source=threshold` alarms in the existing alarm board.
- 2. Per-metric display refresh cadence** on the encounter console: HR/SpO₂ every 10 s, RR every 30 s, temp every 60 s, BP every 120 s. The server poll still runs every 1 s (`TELEMETRY_POLL_MS` unchanged), but the client only COMMITS the displayed value at each metric's cadence — matching real bedside monitor refresh rates. Operator scene/inject / override forces immediate refresh because the latest server value differs from the last committed value.
- 3. ECG trace cosmetic fix:** stroke-width 1.4 → 0.7, color #5dffae (saturated neon) → #7fc99a (muted green). Removes the glow effect; trace looks like a real bedside monitor.

2. Structure

Files touched:

- `portal/control_room.py` — `ControlRoom` gets ``alarm_thresholds``:

```
dict[str, Any] with sensible adult-norm defaults: `python {"hr": {"low": 50, "high": 120}, "spo2": {"low": 90, "high": None}, "rr": {"low": 8, "high": 30}, "dangerous_rhythms": ["vfib", "asystole", "vtach"]}` ``
```

- `portal/alarms.py` — `active_alarms(room)` now merges in

threshold-breach alarms from a new `_threshold_alarms_for(room, enc)` helper. The helper: 1. Pulls the encounter's telemetry via `telemetry.snapshot(enc.id, jitter=False)` (deterministic so threshold checks don't oscillate across the boundary). 2. For each of HR/SpO₂/RR, checks against the room's bounds dict. Below low or above high raises an alarm. SpO₂ breaches are `severity=critical`; HR/RR are `warning`. 3. For ECG: if `enc.ecg_enabled` AND `enc.ecg_rhythm_id` is in the room's `dangerous_rhythms` list → `critical` alarm. - Threshold alarms use `ts=0` so they always sort to the END of their severity bucket — actual device/scene alarms (with a real timestamp) keep the top of the alarm board. This preserves the M26 alarm-bus invariants.

- `portal/server.py` — two new routes:
- `GET /api/room/alarm_thresholds` — read current room thresholds. - `POST /api/room/alarm_thresholds` — operator updates them. Body is a partial dict (any key absent is left untouched). Numeric coercion + sanity-check on each bound.
- `portal/templates/nurse_station.html` — new `<section class="ns-thresholds">` between the alarm board and the bed grid. Form with HR/SpO₂/RR low+high inputs + dangerous-rhythm checkboxes (data-danger attribute).
- `portal/static/nurse_station.js` — `loadThresholds()` GETs and pre-fills the form on page load; `saveThresholds(ev)` POSTs on submit. Both wired via the `DOMContentLoaded` handler.
- `portal/static/nurse_station.css` — new `.ns-thresholds`, `.threshold-row`, `.threshold-label`, `.ns-btn-primary` styles (dark theme matching the supervisor view).
- `portal/static/ecg_strip.js` — `stroke-width '1.4' → '0.7'`, `color #5dffae → #7fc99a` for both path stroke + label fill.
- `portal/static/encounter_console.css` — `.ecg-canvas` text color also bumped from `#5dffae` to `#7fc99a` so the placeholder text + label match the new trace.
- `portal/static/encounter_console.js` — Telemetry rewrite:
- New `METRIC_CADENCE_MS` table per metric (`hr/sbp/dbp/spo2/rr/temp_f`).
- New `_committed + _committedAt` per-metric state.
- New `_maybeCommit(metric, value, now)` helper — commits when cadence elapsed OR value changed (inject/override). - `pollTelemetry()` reads each metric's committed value instead of the raw server reading.

3. Uses

3.1 Operator sets thresholds

1. Operator opens the Nursing Station (`/portal/control/launch_nurse_station` from the master, or scans the QR). 2. Scrolls to "Alarm thresholds" card. Defaults are pre-filled. 3. Types new bounds (e.g. HR 60-100 instead of 50-120). 4. Ticks the "v-fib" + "v-tach" + "asystole" boxes (the default dangerous list). 5. Clicks **Save thresholds**. POST round-trip; status text confirms "saved · 14:32:18".

3.2 Breach surfaces on the alarm board

1. Some time later a scene drops Bed 2's SpO₂ to 84. 2. Next `/api/room/alarms` tick (the Nursing Station polls every 3 s) the room calls `_threshold_alarms_for(room, bed2)`, which resolves `SpO2=84 < 90 → critical alarm "SpO2 low (84 < 90)"`. 3. The alarm shows up on the supervisor alarm board sorted under real-time scene/device criticals. 4. When the operator re-injects vitals back to SpO₂=95, the threshold breach goes away on the next read — no operator click required (auto-resolves when the underlying value returns to range).

3.3 Per-metric display cadence

The Per-Patient Console telemetry strip used to refresh every metric every 1 s. After M48:

- HR + SpO₂ commit every 10 s (close to continuous).
- RR commits every 30 s.
- Temp commits every 60 s.
- BP commits every 120 s.

When the operator injects a `vitals.drop` scene OR sets an override, the server value changes — the client's commit logic notices the diff and refreshes immediately, regardless of cadence.

3.4 ECG before / after

	Pre-M48	Post-M48
stroke-width	1.4	0.7
stroke color	#5dffae (saturated neon green)	#7fc99a (muted green)
visual	"glowing" against dark canvas	natural monitor trace

4. Functions (exported API surface)

Symbol	Where	Purpose
<code>ControlRoom.alarm_thresholds</code>	<code>portal/control_room.py</code>	Room-level thresholds dict.
<code>GET /api/room/alarm_thresholds</code>	<code>portal/server.py</code>	Read current room thresholds.
<code>POST /api/room/alarm_thresholds</code>	<code>portal/server.py</code>	Operator updates. Partial dict body.
<code>_threshold_alarms_for(room, enc)</code>	<code>portal/alarms.py</code>	Internal helper that emits the threshold-breach alarm list.
<code>METRIC_CADENCE_MS + _maybeCommit</code>	<code>portal/static/encounter_console.js</code>	Per-metric refresh cadence on the encounter console.

5. Limitations

- **No engine-side vitals drift.** Pre-M48 the engine's value

doesn't drift naturally — it only changes on scene inject or override. M48 adds **display cadence** (commit-on-cadence) but not **value drift**. So between injects, the BP display "refreshes" every 2 minutes but commits the same value — visually no change. Realistic medical drift (HR ± 2 , SpO₂ ± 1 over a few minutes) is M49 territory and requires a server-side ticker that calls `_apply_drift()` per metric per cadence.

- **Thresholds are room-level, not per-encounter.** A high-risk

patient and a stable post-op share the same thresholds. The operator can adapt by tuning bounds wider/tighter. A future M49 could add a per-encounter override layer.

- **Threshold alarms can't be cleared.** Unlike device/scene

alarms (which have an explicit `/api/alarm/{id}/clear` route), threshold alarms auto-resolve when the underlying value returns to range. Operators can SILENCE the cause (raise bound, inject correction) but not "clear" the breach itself. Documented; matches real bedside monitor semantics.

- **Dangerous rhythm detection is binary.** Either the

encounter's `ecg_rhythm_id` is in the danger list or it isn't. Real monitors detect arrhythmias from the waveform (e.g. detected v-tach episode mid-recording). The v7 model is simulation-driven so this binary check matches the rhythm- picker UX.

- **Cadence is hard-coded** in JS. A future operator-facing

setting could let supervisors tune their preferred refresh rates. Out of scope today.

6. Test status

Test file	Asserts	Status	Last run
tests/v7/test_alarm_thresholds_and_ecg_fix.py::test_thresholds_get_returns_defaults	Default thresholds round-trip from GET	PASS	2026-05-27
...::test_thresholds_post_updates_and_persists	POST update reflects on next GET	PASS	2026-05-27
...::test_thresholds_post_rejects_non_numeric_bound	Bad number → 400	PASS	2026-05-27
...::test_threshold_breach_surfaces_on_room_alarms	HR override > high → alarm in room feed with source=threshold	PASS	2026-05-27
...::test_threshold_breach_spo2_is_critical	SpO ₂ breaches are critical-severity	PASS	2026-05-27
...::test_threshold_breach_below_low_bound	Below-low bound also alarms	PASS	2026-05-27
...::test_threshold_dangerous_rhythm_raises_when_ecg_enabled	Rhythm alarm only when ECG enabled; toggling off clears it	PASS	2026-05-27
...::test_ecg_trace_uses_thinner_stroke_and_muted_color	stroke-width=0.7, color=#7fc99a	PASS	2026-05-27
...::test_ecg_canvas_color_matches_trace	Canvas text color matches new muted green	PASS	2026-05-27
...::test_encounter_console_js_has_per_metric_cadence_table	METRIC_CADENCE_MS table + _maybeCommit + _committed.* present	PASS	2026-05-27
...::test_nurse_station_renders_threshold_form	Nurse Station HTML carries the threshold-settings form with all 6 inputs + dangerous-rhythm checkboxes	PASS	2026-05-27

Test file	Asserts	Status	Last run
Full v7 suite	343 passed, 1 skipped (M20 Playwright skip — unchanged)	PASS	2026-05-27

7. Change list

Date	Author	Change	Files
2026-05-27	claude-code	Initial M48: ControlRoom.alarm_thresholds + 2 routes + alarms.py _threshold_alarms_for; Nurse Station threshold settings card; per-metric cadence display on the encounter console; ECG stroke + color cosmetic fix; 11 new tests	portal/control_room.py, portal/alarms.py, portal/server.py, portal/templates/nurse_station.html, portal/static/nurse_station.{js,css}, portal/static/encounter_console.{js,css}, portal/static/ecg_strip.js, tests/v7/test_alarm_thresholds_and_ecg_fix.py (new)

8. Open questions / known issues

- **Engine-side vitals drift** is the biggest missing piece (see

§5). A future M49 would add a `_apply_drift(enc)` ticker called from the existing alarm-bus poll (or its own task) that randomly walks $HR \pm 1$, $SpO_2 \pm 0$ (rare), $RR \pm 0.5$ etc per cadence. Operator inject still wins because the simulation writes a fresh `vitals.record` that overrides drift.

- **Per-encounter threshold override** — a high-risk patient may

warrant tighter bounds than a stable post-op. A future refinement could add

`enc.alarm_thresholds_override: dict | None` that, if set, layers on top of the room defaults. Out of scope for M48.

- **Threshold breaches in the cohort debrief.** The M14 PEARLS

debrief reads the `chart_event` log. Threshold-breach alarms aren't currently written to that log — they're computed from the telemetry snapshot at read time. A future module could also emit a `vitals.breach` `chart_event` so the debrief shows the breach timeline.

- **Operator-facing settings persistence.** Thresholds reset on

server restart (room dies, in-memory state goes with it). A future M49 could persist thresholds to SQLite alongside other room state.

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